



LIBRARY

Pamphlets, newspapers, and books circulated through the tavern — literacy spread from these tables



STORE

Goods were bought and sold; auctions were held. Tavern keepers were early America's arbitrators.



GARRISON

Military units used taverns as staging points; and organized battle plans there



SCHOOL

In areas without formal schools, basic instruction and public lectures took place at taverns



INN + TAVERN

Food, drink, lodging, warmth, and community — the original product that started everything

1634

Samuel Cole opens Boston's first licensed tavern, Cole's Inn, on March 4th

Source: Star Tavern, startavern.net

1 PER 130

Ratio of taverns to residents; mandated by law in colonial New England settlements

Source: Colonial Williamsburg Foundation; Gettysburg Historical Journal

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Towns without a tavern were sanctioned — the tavern was critical to commerce

Source: Star Tavern, startavern.net

HOSPITALITY IN POLITICS

THE GREEN DRAGON & THE BIRTH OF A NATION

The American Revolution wasn't born in legislative halls—it took shape in taverns. These spaces didn't just support the revolution; they made it structurally possible.

The Green Dragon Tavern in Boston served as the headquarters of the Sons of Liberty. The Green Dragon was where **Samuel Adams, Paul Revere, John Hancock, and James Otis** gathered to plan boycotts of English goods while planning the Boston Tea Party. "they chose tea because they didn't want to lose the rum."^[1] *startavern.net*

THE REVOLUTIONARY TAVERN NETWORK

GREEN DRAGON TAVERN, Boston

Sons of Liberty HQ. Adams, Revere, Hancock, Otis organized the Boston Tea Party there.

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CITY TAVERN, Philadelphia

Continental Congress delegates met here. Founding Fathers drafted strategy over a good meals and lively drinks.

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